



ASSESSMENT REPORT

AI Marketing Readiness Assessment

Full readiness framework, use-case guide, and implementation roadmap

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About this report

This guide accompanies the AI Marketing Readiness Assessment at consult-ds.com/insights/ai-marketing-readiness. It covers the full readiness framework, use-case requirements for each AI application in marketing, governance requirements for regulated industries, and a sequenced implementation roadmap including how IBM watsonx addresses compliance requirements for AI in regulated-sector marketing.

The AI readiness framework

AI readiness for marketing is assessed across three dimensions, weighted by their relative impact on whether AI tools produce reliable and compliant outputs.

Dimension	Weight and rationale	Common gaps
Data quality	45%: AI output quality is bounded by input data quality. A model trained on dirty data produces confident wrong outputs.	Duplicate records, inconsistent field formats, missing behavioural data, no unified contact profile.
Stack integration	35%: AI tools need programmatic access to read data and write outputs back into workflows.	No API access, one-way MAP-CRM sync, missing consent records, no data governance framework.
Team and governance	20%: AI without accountable ownership produces compounding risk as scope expands.	No AI policy, no named owner, no change control process, no staff who can validate model outputs.

Use-case requirements

Each AI application in marketing has distinct minimum requirements before a pilot is likely to produce reliable results.

AI-driven lead scoring

- + Minimum 6 months of conversion history with 500 or more positive conversion events.
- + Clean, structured contact-level data with standardised field formats.
- + Bidirectional CRM and MAP integration so scores can be written back and trigger workflows.
- + A named owner to monitor score distributions and retrain the model quarterly.

Personalisation at scale

- + Unified contact profile consolidating activity from all channels into a single record.
- + Behavioural data at the contact level: web visits, email engagement, in-product events.
- + Auditable consent records stored at the contact level and queryable for compliance.
- + API access to your MAP and CRM for real-time profile reads and content decisions.

Predictive campaign analytics

- + Minimum 12 months of structured campaign performance data in a queryable system.
- + Consistent UTM tagging across all channels so campaign data is comparable.
- + API access to pull campaign data programmatically and feed it into the model.
- + A metric definition register so the model trains on consistently defined outcomes.

AI content generation (governed)

- + A documented AI usage policy covering brand voice, factual accuracy, and approval workflow.
- + A content change control process governing what AI-generated content goes live.
- + A named content owner accountable for quality, tone, and compliance review.
- + A prompt library with approved templates enforcing brand and regulatory constraints.



Regulated industry requirements

In financial services, healthcare, and similar sectors, AI-driven marketing decisions must be explainable, auditable, and defensible under applicable frameworks.

Requirement	Why it matters	Implementation approach
Model explainability	If an AI model deprioritises a contact, the business must explain the basis for that decision.	Use models with explainability outputs (SHAP values). Document the logic in plain language for compliance teams.
Audit trail	Regulators need to trace what data drove a model decision and when.	Log every model decision: input features, output score, timestamp, and model version.
Consent and data usage	Using personal data for AI personalisation without a valid lawful basis is a regulatory breach.	Consent records must be auditable at the contact level. AI tools must not access data for contacts without a valid processing basis.
Model governance	AI models degrade over time as market conditions and data quality shift.	Implement quarterly model health reviews covering score distribution and data quality inputs.
IBM watsonx.governance	Provides model monitoring, explainability, and audit trails for regulated enterprise deployments.	Covers AI lifecycle governance from development through deployment and monitoring, with documentation outputs suitable for regulatory review.

Implementation roadmap by readiness level

Not ready: build the data foundation first

- 1 Run a contact database audit before selecting any AI tool. Identify duplicates, inconsistent field formats, and records with missing or invalid key fields.
- 2 Build a unified contact record by connecting all data sources to a single system of record. AI personalisation based on partial data performs worse than rule-based segmentation.
- 3 Review your consent framework with legal counsel. Consent records must be stored at the contact level, auditable on demand, and granular enough to cover AI-driven personalisation.
- 4 Do not buy an AI marketing tool yet. Every tool you buy without the data foundations in place will need to be reconnected and revalidated when the foundations are ready.

Foundation building: connect the stack

- 1 Enable API access to your CRM and MAP with the permissions required for read and write operations.
- 2 Implement a data governance framework: define field ownership, establish change control, and document data lineage for your key contact and opportunity objects.
- 3 Start collecting behavioural data systematically. Web sessions, email engagement, and product activity at the contact level are the signals that make AI personalisation better than rule-based logic.
- 4 Draft an AI usage policy. A one-page document covering approved use cases, approval workflow, and data usage limits is a sufficient starting point.



Ready to pilot: run a controlled first use case

- 1 Select one use case and define it end-to-end: the data inputs, the model or tool, the output action, the primary metric, and the decision point at 90 days.
- 2 Assign a named AI owner with accountability for data quality inputs, model performance, and governance.
- 3 Run the pilot in parallel with your existing process. Compare AI-scored leads against existing qualification criteria without replacing the existing process until the delta is understood.
- 4 Document everything. The pilot documentation becomes your governance template for future use cases and your evidence base if a regulatory question is raised.

Ready to scale: extend governance before coverage

- 1 Move from single-model to multi-model by adding a second use case only after the first has completed its 90-day validation and produced documented results.
- 2 Build a model monitoring dashboard tracking score distribution shifts, conversion correlation, and data quality inputs quarterly.
- 3 Extend your AI policy to cover partner and agency workflows. If external teams use AI to create content or run campaigns on your behalf, your governance framework must cover their work.
- 4 Commission an independent AI governance review annually, particularly in regulated industries.

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Ready to close the gap?

DS Consulting provides advisory plus implementation across CRM governance, marketing automation, revenue attribution, and IBM watsonx AI for regulated enterprises.

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